

Obsession is the Multiplier. Balance is the Scam.

Visual reference cards from the Monday 11 May session led by director Corie Dawson. Use alongside the Session 1 and 2 toolkits. Print, pin to your wall, or keep on your desk.

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Where is your obsession today?

The obsession audit

You've already proven you can be obsessed. The question is no longer CAN you — it's WHERE you choose to spend it.

ASK YOURSELF: WHERE HAVE I BEEN OBSESSED BEFORE?

Tick every one that applies to you. Then look at where your career sits on this list.



University / study

Tens of thousands invested, often paid yourself. Late nights. Rushed assignments handed in at 2 a.m. Four years of grinding.

And often — for a qualification that doesn't apply to your current job.



Sport / a serious hobby

National-level performance requires every meal, every late night, every weekend optimised around the goal. People do this voluntarily, for years.

Nobody pays you to be obsessed about sport. You did it because you wanted to win.



Dating someone you really like

Two minutes after meeting them, you remember everything. Their dog's name. Their cousin's degree. Their pescatarian preference.

Obsessive recall is automatic. You don't have to force it.



Pursuing a personal goal

Saving for something. Renovating a house. Training for an event. When you wanted it, you found the hours.

Time isn't the issue — priority is.



Your sales career

How does the effort here compare to the four above? Be honest.

THE GAP

If your career effort is lower than ANY of the above, you have a deliberate choice to make.

THE RULE

Obsession is not a personality trait. It's a choice you've already made elsewhere. Redirect a third of it to your career and watch what happens.

Effort vs results

Hours worked is a comforting metric. It gives you a story to tell when results aren't there. Your manager only measures one thing.

HOURS WORKED

the metric that protects ego

WHAT IT MEASURES

Time at desk. Late starts. Long lunches. Email volume.

WHAT IT REWARDS

Looking busy. Appearing committed. Performative effort.

WHEN IT'S USEFUL

Never. It correlates with nothing the business actually needs.

WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE

"I'm trying my best." "I stayed late again." "I'm doing what I can."

THE QUIET STORY

It gives you something to point at when results aren't there — a way to feel like you did your part.

RESULTS

the only metric that matters

WHAT IT MEASURES

Deals closed. Quotas hit. Quizzes passed. Behaviours adopted.

WHAT IT REWARDS

Outcomes. Skill. Preparation. Real client wins.

WHEN IT'S USEFUL

Always. It's the only thing the business runs on.

WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE

"I closed 11 last week." "I passed the quiz first attempt."

THE QUIET STORY

There's nowhere to hide. Either it happened or it didn't. That's why most people avoid this frame — and why it's the only one worth using.

QUOTE

"I'm not interested in how hard you work. I'm just interested in whether you're achieving the results." — Corie

Balance is a scam

The cultural idea of “work-life balance” is a comforting story average people tell themselves. People with outlier outcomes don’t describe their journey as balanced.

“BALANCED” LIFE

the average outcome

WORK

9 to 5. Weekends sacred. Holidays for the calendar.

INPUT

Average hours. Average effort. Average preparation.

INCOME

Salary + ~5% annual rise. Bounded.

ASSETS

Mortgage that owns you back. Maybe one rental in 20 years.

STORY

“It’s about balance. Money isn’t everything.”

OUTCOME

Comfortable. Forgettable. Same in 10 years.

OBSESSED LIFE

the outlier outcome

WORK

Whatever the goal requires. Including 24-hour stretches when it matters.

INPUT

Outlier hours during the build phase. Compounded preparation. Visible obsession.

INCOME

Ownership equity, performance pay, business cash flow. Unbounded.

ASSETS

Multiple properties. Real cash flow. Optionality.

STORY

“I’m obsessed. Balance was a luxury I didn’t afford yet.”

OUTCOME

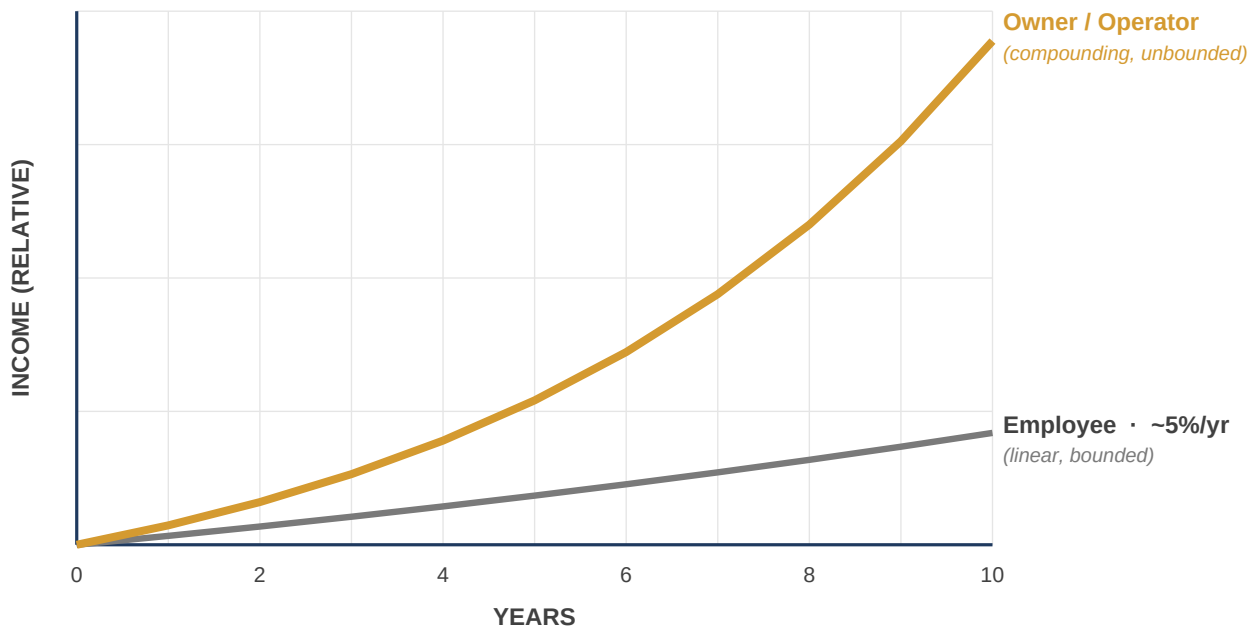
Memorable. Compounding. Unrecognisable in 10 years.

TO BE CLEAR

This isn’t a recommendation to work 100-hour weeks forever. It’s a recommendation to be honest: if you want the average outcome, run the average schedule. If you want the outlier outcome, accept the outlier schedule — at least for the period of your life where it matters most.

The 5% career ceiling

Employee compensation is linear and bounded. Ownership compensation is exponential and unbounded. Know which game you're playing.



EMPLOYEE TRACK

Growth is bounded by what an employer can justify paying. Annual rises ~5%. Even brilliant performance rarely breaks 10%.

After 10 years: you're earning ~60% more than you started.

OWNER / OPERATOR TRACK

Growth comes from equity, commission, ownership, compounding skill, network, and reputation. No ceiling.

After 10 years: you're earning 5–10x more than you started — if you're obsessed.

The competition you can't see

Your closest competitor isn't the rep at the next desk. It's the obsessed person you've never met — working harder than you because they have no plan B.

THE OBSESSED OPERATOR

an example you'll never meet

BACKGROUND

Tradesman apprentice. New to the country. Family overseas depending on remittances.

WEEKDAYS

Full day on a building site, 7 a.m. — 4 p.m.

EVENINGS

Uber driving from 6 p.m. — midnight.

WEEKENDS

Side jobs. Studying for licenses. Pooling capital with cousins.

MENTAL MODEL

No plan B. Obsession is necessity, not personality.

WHERE IN 10 YEARS

Multiple properties. Owns a small business. Extended family pooling for the next acquisition.

THE COMPLACENT LOCAL

could be any of us

BACKGROUND

Educated. Degree paid for. House. Roof. "Doing fine."

WEEKDAYS

9-to-5 in a sales role. Occasionally stays back.

EVENINGS

Time off. Social plans. "I'm busy."

WEEKENDS

Sacred. Recovery. "I work hard during the week."

MENTAL MODEL

"I'm already set up." Plan B is the parents' spare room. Obsession feels excessive.

WHERE IN 10 YEARS

Same job. Same pay band. Wondering where the time went. Watching the obsessed operator overtake.

THE POINT

The difference between these two people isn't intelligence, opportunity, or luck. It's obsession. One has it by necessity; the other chooses not to bring it. The market doesn't care which.

The most dangerous sentence

“I’m already set up.” — If you catch yourself thinking it, treat it like a fire alarm.

THE SENTENCE

“I’m already set up.”

WHY IT’S DANGEROUS

Because it might be technically true today. You ARE doing okay relative to where you started. That’s exactly what makes it the most damaging thought you can carry. The moment you accept the frame, you stop running the magnets. You stop pulling success in. You stop pushing failure away. And in 5–10 years, the people who never accepted that frame have lapped you — and there’s no catching back up.

WHAT TO THINK INSTEAD

“I’m at the bottom of my career.”

Said honestly, this is the most useful sentence a rep at any stage can carry. It’s bad news — because there’s nowhere lower. It’s also liberating — because every direction is up. Where would your effort go if you genuinely believed it?

THE CHECK

Catch the sentence the moment it surfaces. “I’ve got a house.” “I’m doing fine.” “I don’t need to grind.” All variations of the same trap. Spot them. Reject them.

Trade-business turnover — the \$100k×3 rule

A refinement of the Session 2 formula. Trade businesses (anything with trucks, materials, sub-contractors) need a multiplier.

THE FORMULA

Service business: $\text{staff} \times \$100,000$

Trade business: $\text{staff} \times \$100,000 \times 3$

WHY THE 3× MULTIPLIER

Trade businesses pass through materials, equipment, sub-contractors, and vehicle costs that service businesses don't. A skip-bin company with 9 staff isn't turning over \$900k — it's closer to \$3M, with margins more like 25–30% rather than the 70%+ services hit. If you pitch a \$900k business when they're actually doing \$3M, you have under-pitched by 70%.

WORKED EXAMPLE FROM THE SESSION

Commercial air-conditioning company, 20 staff, trade business.

- STEP 1** Apply service formula: $20 \times \$100,000 = \2M turnover.
- STEP 2** It's a trade business (vehicles, materials). Apply multiplier: $\$2\text{M} \times 3 = \6M turnover.
- STEP 3** Allow for seasonal upside: \$6M to \$8M plausible range.
- STEP 4** Break to weekly value: $\$6\text{M} \div 50 \text{ weeks} = \120k/week .
- STEP 5** Pitch our package as a fraction of one week. Anchor accordingly.

EXAMPLES

SERVICE (use ×1): accounting firm, marketing agency, law practice, consultancy, financial advisor.

TRADE (use ×3): plumbing, electrical, HVAC/air-con, skip bins, landscaping, building, removalists, mechanics, pest control.

Daily mindset card

Read every morning before your first call. Print this page. Pin it to your monitor.

TODAY'S QUESTION

Where is my obsession today?

AUDIT

Where in your life are you bringing obsessive effort right now? Is your career on that list — or somewhere else?

CONTINUITY

Have you reviewed the notes from the last training? If not, you're about to waste everyone's time, including your own.

RESULTS

Hours don't count. Outcomes do. What got done yesterday? What will get done today?

BALANCE

If you wanted the average outcome you'd run an average schedule. You don't want the average outcome. Schedule accordingly.

TRUTH

When something didn't happen, the honest sentence is "I should have prioritised it." Use that one, not the polite excuse.

Obsession is the multiplier. Balance is the scam.

— Corie Dawson